

Creepy-crawlies

The creepy-crawly section contains some of the most extraordinary-looking animals on Earth.



Largest moth: The atlas moth is often mistaken for a bird. It is 30 cm (12 in) wide.



Biggest eye: the giant squid has the largest eye of any living animal.



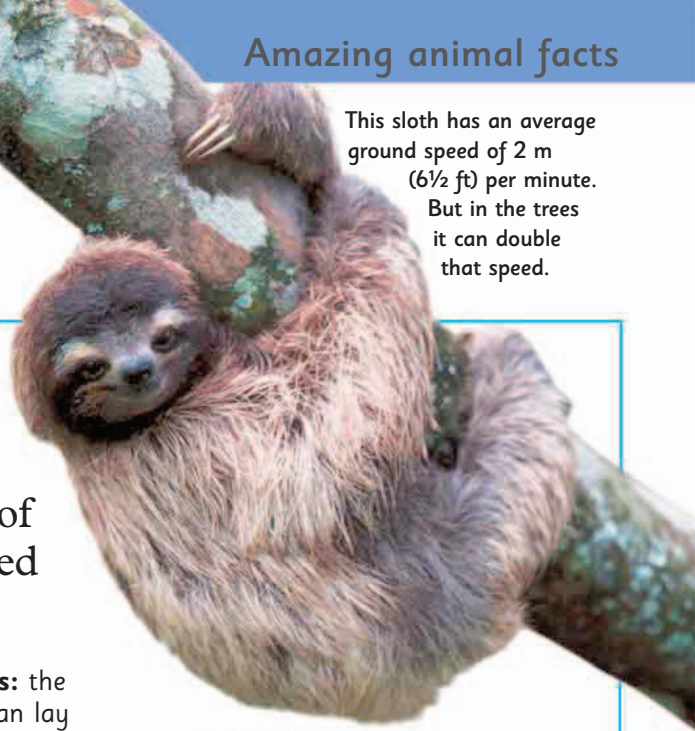
Largest spider: the Goliath bird-eating spider would easily cover a plate.



Most legs: the animal with the most legs is the millipede – some have 750!

The three-toed sloth of South America is the slowest mammal on Earth.

This sloth has an average ground speed of 2 m (6½ ft) per minute. But in the trees it can double that speed.



Fish

Fish dominate the water world – and the majority of the Earth is covered in water.



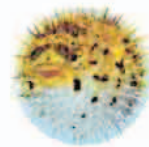
Most fish eggs: the ocean sunfish can lay 30 million eggs at one spawning.



Largest fish: the whale shark is the largest fish in the world.



Largest freshwater fish: the European catfish is the largest freshwater fish.

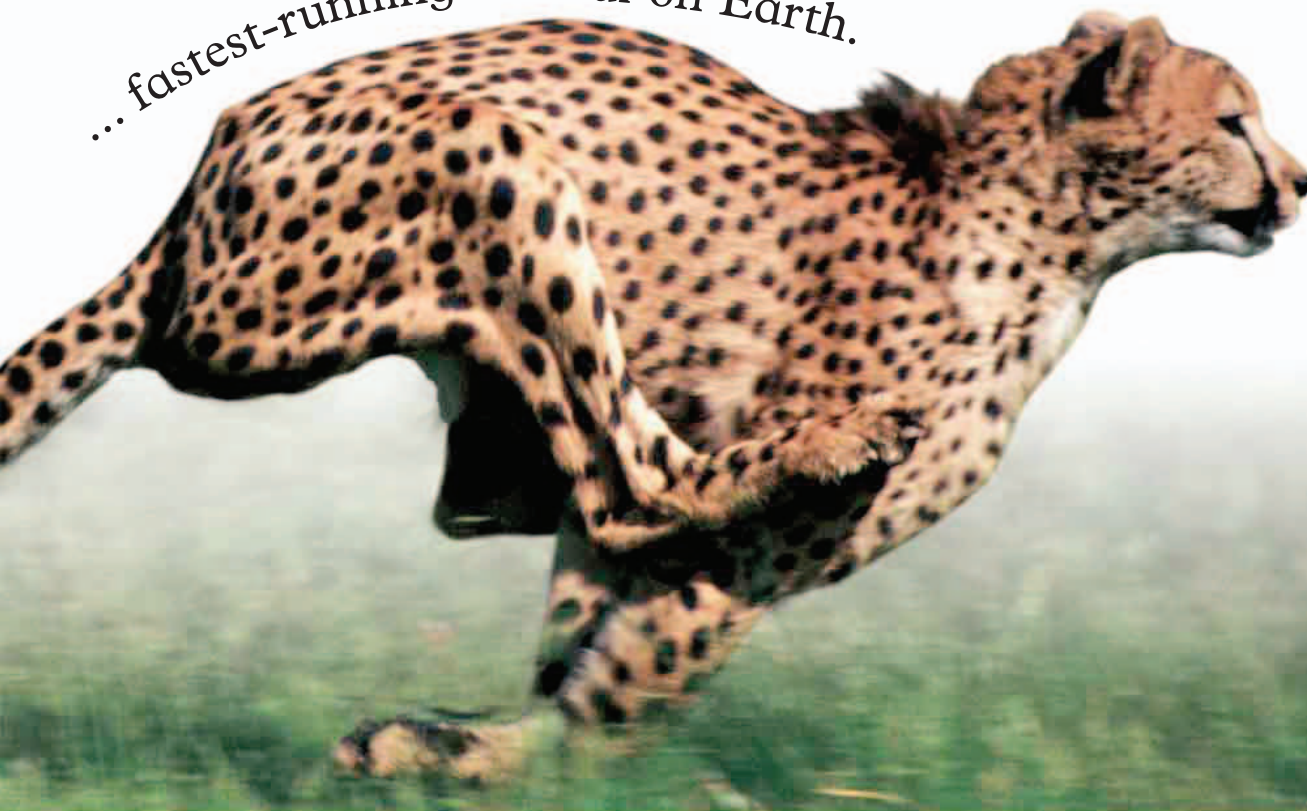


Prickliest fish: as well as spines, porcupine fish also have sharp teeth.



Fastest fish: the sailfish can swim faster than the cheetah can run (see below).

... fastest-running animal on Earth.



Cheetahs run amazingly fast. When they are chasing prey on level ground, they can reach speeds of over 100 kph (62 mph) in short bursts.